Type 2 Diabetes in South Asians

What is Diabetes?

A chronic disease caused by high blood sugar levels. The body does not respond to insulin, the hormone that helps move sugar from the blood into our body cells for energy. Complications include heart disease, stroke, kidney disease, nerve damage and more.



Why are South Asians at a greater risk of diabetes?

South Asians **(India, Pakistan, Bangladesh)** are more likely to store belly fat (visceral fat). Increased fat around the stomach increases insulin resistance. South Asians are also genetically predisposed to produing lower levels of insulin

Risk Factors include:

- Family history
- Over the age of 25
- BMI greater than 23
- High blood pressure
- High Cholesterol

Get Screened today! Ask your physician about HbA1c testing

How can you reduce your risk?

- Get physical activity everyday! Even 30 minutes a day can reduce your risk
- Increase fiber in your diet through increased vegetables and fruits
- Eat three meals at a regular time each day
- Check HbA1c and Cholesterol levels during annual check-ups

References:
- https://www.diabetes.org.uk/node/12895
- https://www.dukehealth.org/blog/diabetes-south-asian-people-what-you-need-know